

and tries to move away from an empiricism which sees the world as a collection of things ('substance metaphysics') to a dynamic view of the world as a succession of events, a world in process. In their interpretation of Romans, Cobb and Lull focus on ideas of 'indwelling' and 'participation' which fits well with Process Philosophy and with Paul. There is, however, a critical comment from the editor – to which Cobb and Lull respond – who accepts that Paul's talk of being 'in Christ' is not mystical but an alternative way of thinking, but who is equally clear that Process Philosophy does not offer a satisfactory way of understanding Paul's own idea.

At least Cobb and Lull know what they are talking about. The central problem in the following section of the book is that the philosophers being discussed are all atheists: Jacques Derrida, Jacob Taubes, Alain Badiou, Giorgio Agamben and the Slovak Slavoj Žižek. Nothing wrong with being atheist necessarily, we do not want to make the Pauline club hermetic. But most admit that they know next to nothing of recent Pauline scholarship, they do not always seem to be familiar with all of Paul's letters or even with all the chapters of Romans. They are incapable of placing Paul in his historical context and some of them actually admit they are not interested in the religious content of Romans (how much does that leave?) as though religious understanding was an irrelevant after-thought for Paul. What is puzzling is why these philosophers should have wanted to write about Paul at all. And what is equally puzzling is why serious readers of Paul should spend much time responding to writers of such intellectual capriciousness and, one might say, intellectual triviality.

These philosophers want to use Paul for their own projects in political philosophy. The authors here seem to regard it as a complement that his letters have become 'classic texts' that are given weight outside the Church and outside the theology faculty. It is, however, a dubious complement given the way the letters are used. Derrida, for example, as summarised by Theodore Jennings, does not supplement traditional readings of Romans so much as sweep them away when he claims that justification has previously been understood as anything but becoming just (in a moral, political sense) and in Reformed doctrine belief becomes 'make believe'. So much for almost two thousand years of Christian culture; it is Derrida we have been waiting for for enlightenment on Romans.

These critical comments are directed against the philosophers who are represented here, not the contributors to this volume, who by and large offer sensible criticisms of their subjects, but they are more appreciative of their subjects than I would be when they praise them for the new perspectives they have opened on reading Paul. There is nothing wrong with this project in principle – Paul's meaning can be discovered in a multiplicity of perspectives – but in practice those seriously interested in understanding Paul are not likely to get much out of this volume. What would have worked – but maybe it is not seen to be 'relevant' – would have been to set Romans against Paul's own history and culture, though a great deal has been written about that already, a body of literature about which our modern atheistic philosophers know nothing.

Harrogate, UK

Geoffrey Turner

Rereading Paul Together: Protestant and Catholic Perspectives on Justification. Edited by David E Aune. Pp. 270. Baker Academic, Grand Rapids, Michigan, 2006, \$24.99.

In 1999 representatives of the Lutheran World Federation and the Roman Catholic Church signed a 'Joint Declaration on the Doctrine of Justification' (not reprinted here but easily available on the internet). Given the history of the last four-hundred years, this was a significant achievement, though inevitably there were some Catholics who said their Church had abandoned the Council of Trent and some Lutherans thought their representatives had sold out to Catholicism. In fact some sticking points remain which suggest there is no 'sell out': Catholic reservations about *simul justus et peccator* whereby Lutherans maintain that believers are right with God and at the same time sinners (in the sense of 'mortal sin' as used by Catholics) because they see concupiscence after baptism as actual sin; and Lutheran reservation about the odd way in which Catholics speak of 'merit' whereby God rewards the believer for his or her actions, actions which come entirely from God's grace, however, and cannot be boasted about. Nonetheless both sides have agreed on the basics – salvation comes entirely from God, it is the result of grace which is available through the achievements of the life, death and resurrection of Jesus Christ. They have also agreed that history has moved on and the condemnations of the sixteenth-century no longer apply to the Churches of the twenty-first century.

This collection comes from a joint meeting of American Lutherans and Catholics sponsored by Valparaiso and Notre Dame Universities in 2002 and focuses on how the two traditions might now read Paul together in the light of this formal agreement. The first three chapters are rooted in the Joint Declaration. David Truemper introduces the document, Susan Wood comments on its Catholic reception, and Michael Root responds as a Lutheran systematic theologian, notable for his vigorous

repudiation of Eberhard Jüngel's objections to the Declaration which are based on a typically Lutheran (though evidently not typical of *all* Lutherans) theology of opposites: gospel not law, grace not works, etc. For Jüngel (not one of the contributors here) 'the doctrine of justification is the one and only criterion for all theological statements'. Joseph Fitzmyer implies that Jüngel and others like him do not read the whole of Paul. In his worthy but well balanced survey of justification in Paul, Fitzmyer shows that justification is only one way in which Paul talks about salvation and only really in two of his letters in which he is responding to a particular form of opposition. Fitzmyer suggests a decahedron of effects of the Christ-event, as he calls it: justification, salvation, reconciliation, expiation, redemption, freedom, sanctification, transformation, new creation and glorification. Margaret Mitchell smooths this out by identifying them not as ten different effects but as 'different metaphorical means . . . for expressing the same, salvific reality'. So, then, not a decahedron of salvific effects but 'different templates or transparencies that can be overlaid in viewing what is for Paul the singly central Christ-event'. Either way, Richard DeMaris agrees from a Lutheran perspective that, in the light of recent Pauline scholarship, we have to decentre justification without underestimating its integral importance. He thinks we need a new language and suggests that of God as a 'benefactor' as an alternative to God as one who justifies or makes righteous.

Much recent work on Romans, particularly the so-called 'New Perspective on Paul', coming from Protestant exegetes, has seriously questioned Luther's and subsequent Lutheran readings of Paul. John Reumann here tries to re-establish something like a Lutheran understanding by setting aside Romans and Galatians to focus on Philippians, and specifically Philippians 3.2–11. Margaret Mitchell does a lot to undermine this position methodologically and at the same time quite correctly warns of the danger of requiring a consensus of New Testament scholars as a precondition of ecumenical advance. Especially, I would add, in the ever more complex and confusing world of Pauline scholarship.

There are also chapters on how Paul was interpreted in the early Church, specifically by Origen, Chrysostom and Augustine, by David Rylaarsdam, and on the interpretation of Paul in the middle ages and Reformation by Randall Zachman, but these are make-weights. What is helpful is a lengthy final chapter by the editor on 'Recent Readings of Paul Relating to Justification by Faith'. For those readers still on the fringe of understanding recent shifts in Pauline studies, this would be a good place to start. These shifts have been provoked by a realisation that Luther got Paul wrong. This is something of a bombshell for Protestant theology which says a lot for the resilience of those who are trying to deal with the after-shock. Within Protestant exegesis there is a dispute between Lutheran and Calvinist readings of Paul, which is not easy to get your head round if you do not come from those traditions. It is a dispute about the status of the law, the value of human actions, and the centrality within theology of justification by faith, among other things. But Catholic scholars need to latch onto this because it would be short-sighted to formally agree with Lutherans in such a way that it cut them adrift in this debate from Calvinists (who would include N. T. Wright) who are the ones who might have a lot to teach us about Paul at the present time.

Harrogate, UK

Geoffrey Turner

Paul, the Pastoral Epistles, and the Early Church. By James W Aageson. Pp. xv, 235, Hendrickson, Peabody, Massachusetts, 2008, £12.99.

What to do with the Pastoral Epistles? The predominant approach is to first ask who wrote them – probably not Paul; then to date them – AD 80–100; then to comment on the text but with the effect of making them somewhat marginal in the NT canon and, within the tradition of Protestant exegesis (particularly post-Harnack), to consign them to a post-Apostolic 'Catholic' development. Aageson's purpose is rather different. He is interested in what they tell us about a Pauline tradition that emerged after Paul and continued into the following centuries. He asks 'What happened to Paul after Paul?'

Aageson's method is descriptive and comparative. He prefers to leave open the questions of the authorship, date, location and context of the Pastoral Epistles in order to compare literary and theological patterns among the three letters themselves and with a range of other 'Pauline' documents. He notes that 1 Timothy and Titus are concerned, among other things, with behaviour in 'the household of God', with ministerial order and with holding to the (unspecified) truth of faith. 2 Timothy is concerned with suffering in the Christian life in a way paralleled most strongly in Philippians. Aageson inclines to the view that 2 Timothy was written by someone other than the author of 1 Timothy and Titus, so not all the Pastorals were written by Paul. Aageson lines up the three Pastoral letters against those undisputed letters of Paul with which they have most often been thought to have a connection: 1 Timothy with 1 Corinthians, 2 Timothy with Philippians, and Titus with Galatians. In each case he finds the connections are tenuous or non-existent. So probably none of them were written by Paul; there were probably three